

One well-liked server-side scripting language for web development is PHP (Hypertext Preprocessor). It was first presented by Rasmus Lerdorf in 1994 and progressed from simple tools for monitoring internet traffic to a powerful programming language. Today, PHP powers more than 75% of websites, including WordPress, and is adored for its ease of use, adaptability, and compatibility. It is a popular option for developers all over the world because of its open source nature and strong community support.

Usage of PHP

PHP as backend: PHP runs WordPress by taking care of server-side functions including database management, form submission processing, and dynamic content delivery. It guarantees seamless communication between the frontend and backend of the website.

Frontend connection: A WordPress website's frontend displays dynamic material to users, such as posts, pages, and widgets, using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript in conjunction with PHP-generated data.

WordPress dependency: Because PHP is used in the development of WordPress, it is essential to the efficient creation, modification, and administration of WordPress themes and plugins.

PHP trends

With the release of PHP 8, PHP continues to advance, becoming more developer-friendly and modern with features like named arguments, union types, and JIT (just-in-time) compilation for improved speed. PHP development innovation is fuelled by well-known frameworks like Laravel and Symfony, which prioritise efficiency, scalability, and modularity. Furthermore, PHP is becoming more and more integrated with cloud services and microservices architecture, which is in line with current web trends. Another new trend is the usage of PHP in headless CMS platforms, which manage content independently of the frontend.

PHP dependence

Because of its close interaction with WordPress, which powers 43% of the internet, PHP is still essential in web development even with the advent of other languages. PHP is used for backend processing in most content management systems (CMS), e-commerce platforms such as WooCommerce, and custom web applications. It remains current due to its extensive hosting support, ease of use, and robust library and framework ecosystem. PHP is still used by businesses who rely on outdated technologies to update and maintain their apps.

PHP system structure

PHP system structure typically follows a model-view-

controller (MVC) pattern, where the *model* represents the data and business logic, the *view* displays the user interface, and the *controller* manages user input and interaction between the model and view. The structure involves PHP scripts running on the server that handle requests, access databases, and serve dynamic content through HTML. A web server, such as Apache or NGINX, processes the PHP code, while a database like MySQL stores and retrieves data. Frameworks like Laravel or Symfony enhance the structure with additional layers for routing, templating, and database management, ensuring clean and maintainable code.

Frameworks of PHP

There are two primary categories of PHP frameworks: micro-frameworks and full-stack frameworks.

Comprehensive libraries, integrated tools, and all-inclusive architecture are features of full-stack frameworks like Laravel, Symfony, and CakePHP that make them ideal for creating intricate applications. For small or API-focused projects, micro-frameworks like Slim and Lumen provide lightweight solutions with few features.

There are two methods to source frameworks. With community-driven development, open source frameworks are publicly accessible and support a vast array of projects (e.g., Laravel, CodeIgniter, Yii). Although they are less prevalent in PHP, commercial frameworks may provide enterprise-level solutions, extra premium support, or customised features.

The project's requirements, such as the level of customisation needed and if scalability, development speed, or performance are the most crucial considerations, will determine which of these options is best. Frameworks provide developers with a foundation upon which to build applications effectively, utilising defined patterns and reused code to expedite development.

Top PHP frameworks you should be familiar with

1 Laravel

Laravel is a modern PHP framework known for its elegant syntax, built-in tools for routing, authentication, and ORM (Eloquent). It's designed for building scalable web applications.

- **Usage:** Ideal for full-stack web applications, APIs, and enterprise-level solutions.
- **Installation:** Install via Composer: `composer create-project --prefer-dist laravel/laravel projectname`
- **Benefits:** Provides an elegant syntax, built-in authentication, powerful routing, and robust ORM.
- **Used by:** Mastercard, 9GAG, and Pfizer